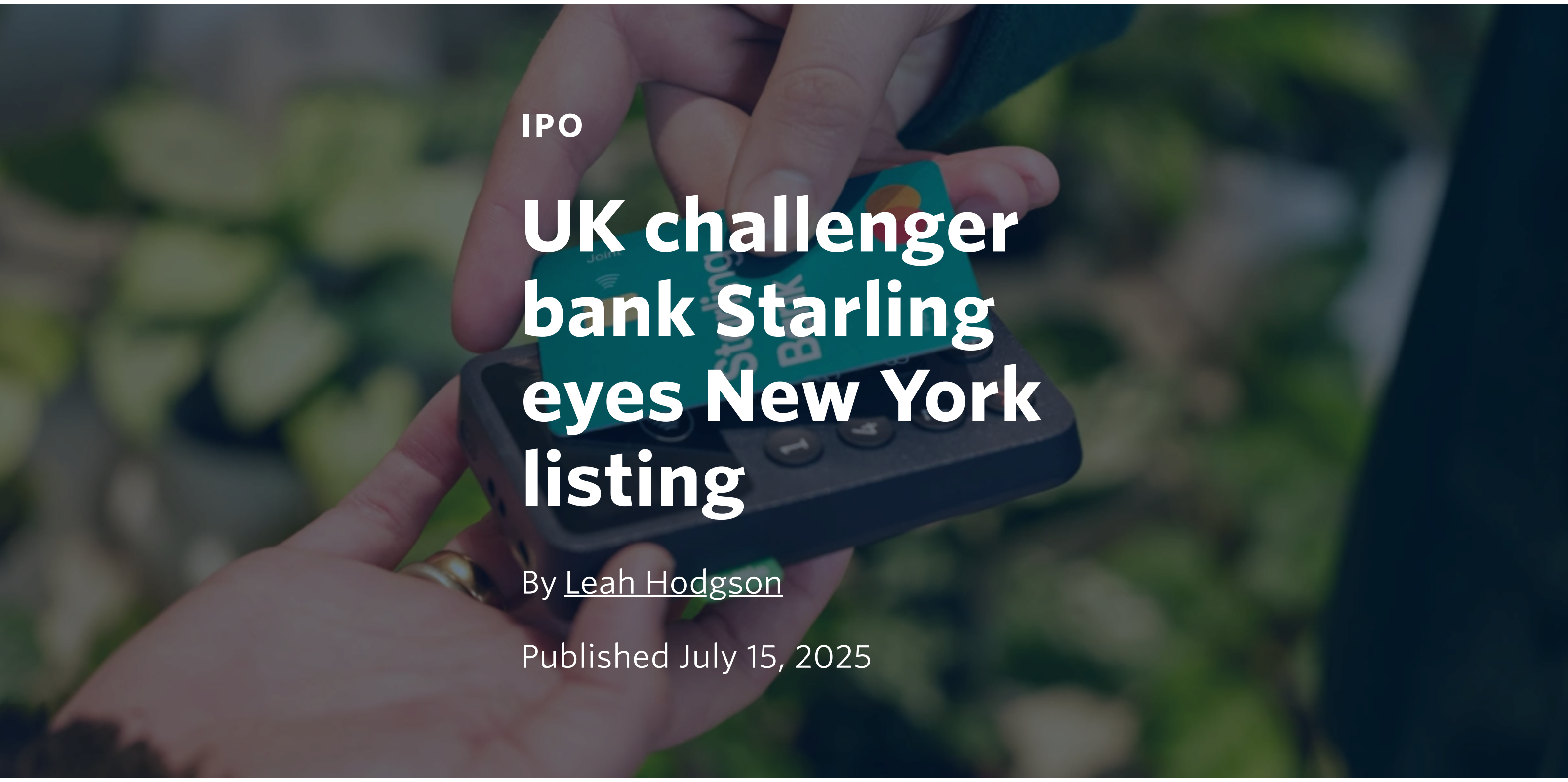

IPO

UK challenger bank Starling eyes New York listing

By Leah Hodgson

Published July 15, 2025

Challenger bank Starling Bank is considering listing in New York over London as it pursues US expansion.

CFO Declan Ferguson told the Financial Times that while the London-based company is in no rush to go to market, it is examining the US as an IPO destination.

According to Ferguson, one contributing factor is the possibility of a higher valuation. Starling is currently valued at £2.5 billion (about $3.4 billion), having raised around $1 billion from investors including Qatar Investment Authority, Fidelity Management & Research and Goldman Sachs.

Starling is unlikely to opt for New York without first establishing a strong presence in the US. The company made its first move across the Atlantic earlier this year and is reportedly looking to buy a nationally chartered bank in the US.

This is a stark departure from Starling's previous stance on a UK listing. The company's former interim chief, John Mountain, stated last year that it was "very committed" to London. If Starling were to opt for New York, it would mark another strong blow to the UK's beleaguered stock market.

Payments company Wise announced last month that it will move its main share listing to the US to attract more investors and capital. Another IPO hopeful, challenger bank Revolut, is also likely to pick the US, with CEO Nik Storonsky saying that a London listing is "not rational." Buy now, pay later company Klarna is also sticking with New York after it postponed its float earlier this year.

The UK government is attempting to keep fintechs in the UK. Last week, finance minister Rachel Reeves met executives from companies including Revolut and Atom to improve growth conditions for the fintech market.

Featured image courtesy of Starling Bank

Learn more about our editorial standards.

About Leah Hodgson

Leah Hodgson is a London-based senior reporter for PitchBook, covering the venture capital ecosystem across Europe and the Middle East. Leah, who joined PitchBook in 2018, graduated from the University of Surrey with a BA in international politics with French. She has previously been a radio reporter in France. She later turned to financial journalism, covering the wealth management industry.

Share:

Tags: IPO Europe Venture Capital

Related content

PE EXITS

5 charts: Traditional PE exits may be reopening—but mainly in North America

August 19, 2025

Europe lagged behind North America in all three routes

FEATURED

'SPAC King' Chamath Palihapitiya is back with a new one

August 18, 2025

The American Exceptionalism Acquisition Corp. will focus on energy, AI, decentralized finance...

IPO

Blockchain-based lender Figure files for IPO

August 18, 2025

The company has been profitable since 2024.

Load More

Products

Solutions

Data

News & Analysis

Follow us

Terms of Use Privacy Policy
Do Not Sell or Share My Personal Information
GDPR Compliance